Nick Sterniotis - Master CV

Formal name: Nikolaos Sterniotis | **Working name:** Nick Sterniotis **Location:** Cork, Ireland | remote-first, any timezone **Email:** nick@sterniotis.com **LinkedIn:** linkedin.com/in/nsterniotis | **GitHub:** github.com/sternnick **Portfolio:** portfolio.sterniotis.com **Target:** Senior infrastructure / platform / SRE roles, remote (Ireland or EU)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Infrastructure and cloud engineer with **20+ years in IT** (elapsed span since April 2000), the last 14 of them in roles titled infrastructure or operations engineering and the last three spent owning production rather than contributing to it: hybrid estates of Linux hosts and containers across two data centres, the pipelines that change them, the monitoring that says when they are wrong, and the automation that is now starting to change them under explicit controls.

Incident owner with 24/7 shift coverage. Effective as the only infrastructure person in the room, and effective as the person a platform team calls when something is quietly broken and nobody can say why. The strongest work is the kind that removes a recurring manual task for good.

CORE SKILLS

- **Linux:** Debian, Ubuntu, RHEL-family, AlmaLinux. Administration, hardening, patch policy, performance triage, diagnosis with `ss` and `nstat` rather than guesswork
- **Virtualisation (production):** Virtuozzo / OpenVZ container hosting, VMware vSphere, Docker and Compose
- **Virtualisation (self-directed):** Proxmox VE and KVM, VLAN-aware bridges, SDN/VNet isolation
- **Cloud and identity:** AWS (Solutions Architect - Professional), hybrid connectivity, Entra ID / Azure AD and Microsoft 365 as the identity plane. Azure platform administration: limited exposure, uncertified
- **Automation and IaC:** Ansible (deployed, gated in CI), Terraform / OpenTofu (declarative definitions validated; not applied to production)
- **CI/CD:** pipelines authored and repaired, self-hosted runners, fail-closed gates, deployment verification
- **Observability:** Prometheus, Grafana, log aggregation, uptime monitoring, alert rules with named recipients
- **Networking:** LAN/WAN, VLAN / 802.1Q, routing, VPN, NAT, firewall zones, reverse proxy, TLS termination, Cisco, OpenWRT
- **Windows and enterprise IT:** Windows Server 2016/2019/2022, Active Directory, Exchange, Group Policy, Veeam-class backup, hardware lifecycle on Dell, HPE, Cisco, APC
- **Scripting:** Python, Bash, PowerShell where the estate demanded it
- **Security practice:** least privilege, change control, secret-scanning gates, ISO 27001 exposure

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Scaleforce (Cyprus) Ltd - Cloud Systems & Operations Engineer

Ireland, remote | Aug 2025 - present | contract, sole trader | 1 yr 2 mths

Continuation of a three-year in-house role after relocation, converted to an external contract. Services Agreement dated 15 Sep 2025; invoicing continuous through Sep 2026. The profile says August and the paper says September; the collaboration continued in August and the agreement was signed in September, and at month granularity there is no gap.

- Sole point of ownership for production cloud and hybrid infrastructure: Linux hosts, container workloads, cloud services, and the network paths joining them
- Incident owner with 24/7 shift coverage: triage, mitigation, full root-cause review, and the runbook that follows the review
- Technical escalation point for engineering and DevOps teams across time zones
- API integrations and scripted workflows written to remove repeated manual operations rather than to automate them once
- Documentation maintained as an operational artefact: runbooks, troubleshooting guides, decision records

Independent IT & Cloud Consultant (self-employed)

Ireland, remote | Aug 2025 - present | part-time, alongside the Scaleforce contract

- Domain registration and DNS architecture for SME and private clients: routing, mail records, and the propagation troubleshooting that follows a change nobody can see yet
- VPS provisioning and Linux hosting setup, with security configured at install time rather than deferred to a later project
- CDN, reverse proxy and TLS termination for performance and secure access
- Remote troubleshooting and technical guidance where there is no internal IT function to escalate to

Scaleforce (Cyprus) Ltd - Cloud Lead Engineer / Architect

Cyprus | Nov 2023 - Aug 2025 | full-time, employed | 1 yr 9 mths

Employment agreement 15 Nov 2023; resignation effective 15 Aug 2025; the employer reference letter names this title. The business was acquired by SIMNET in Oct 2025, after this period.

- Owned Linux production infrastructure across two data centres (Cyprus and Amsterdam) with Virtuozzo / OpenVZ container hosting and Docker workloads
- Led the hybrid transition from an on-premises base: compute, networking and system-integration decisions, and their staged rollout with a rollback point at each step
- Architecture authority for the workloads that could not move, and for the dependencies that meant they should not
- Moved fault detection ahead of failure by instrumenting the paths first and writing alert rules with named recipients and actions, instead of adding a dashboard
- Built the container hosting layer: placement, lifecycle, migrations, and incident ownership on a service with 24/7 shift coverage

FXGlobe - IT Support Engineer

Cyprus, hybrid | Jul 2023 - Oct 2023 | contract | 4 mths

Forex trading infrastructure, where latency and availability are directly revenue. Scope per the CTO's reference letter of 01 Nov 2023: "both our local office and cloud infrastructure", with network security configured for local and overseas offices.

- Infrastructure change management and cloud operations supporting a trading platform across multiple time zones
- Escalation point for complex infrastructure and networking faults; VoIP and softphone deployment across all branches, with SIP and QoS decisions
- L1 and L2 support scope: **250+ users globally, 35+ at the office** (the split is what reconciles the two figures in circulation)
- Initiated an IT ticketing workflow and introduced onboarding and offboarding; ran procurement and vendor management
- Hardware lifecycle from procurement through installation to decommissioning, plus user guides and training material

Simplex-Cyprus - IT Operations Engineer (field / on-site)

Larnaca, Cyprus, on-site | May 2022 - Jun 2023 | full-time | 1 yr 2 mths

ICT solutions provider and data-centre operator; the most advanced data centre on the island, ISO 27001.

- Data-centre operations across a multi-site estate: VMware vSphere, Windows Server, storage, patch windows and hardware lifecycle on Dell, HPE, Cisco and APC equipment
- **50-80 tickets weekly** handled across L1 support and field engineering
- Microsoft 365 and Azure AD administration, email and file-sharing services
- Router, switch and firewall administration, VPN setup and remote-support provisioning
- Backup procedures implemented with recovery testing and validation, service and availability monitoring

Konstantinos Kokkinos - IT Operations & Infrastructure Consultant

Remote | Jul 2021 - Apr 2022 | contract | 9 mths

The same client relationship moved to consulting after the field years.

- Microsoft 365, Linux and general operations work delivered remotely
- Change of delivery model, not of client: the account ran continuously from 2005 to 2022 across three contract forms

Konstantinos Kokkinos - IT Field & Infrastructure Engineer

Greece, nationwide, on-site | Apr 2012 - Jul 2021 | full-time | 9 yrs 4 mths

The long middle of the career. Employed by an IT consulting and field-services practice whose client base was retail chains, public sector bodies, financial institutions and enterprise organisations, with partner contracts sourced through system integrators.

- Designed, supported and optimised infrastructure for organisations with no infrastructure department: servers, networking, storage, backups, early cloud
- Owned the whole decision chain including what not to buy, which is the part that teaches judgement
- Windows Server and Linux systems, Active Directory, hardware and network installation, remote-support capability for distributed sites
- Field engineering across Greece on enterprise engagements: POS and retail networks, migrations, and support for systems that could not stop
- Delivered alongside larger integrators on contracts won by system-integration partners, which is where the enterprise hardware and vendor exposure came from

Career break

2010 - 2012 | career break

Stated because the live profile states it. A two-year hole that a CV leaves blank is a question an interviewer asks; a hole that a CV names is a question they do not.

Konstantinos Kokkinos - IT Support Technician

Greece | Mar 2005 - Dec 2009 | full-time | 4 yrs 10 mths

- Network engineering and troubleshooting across on-site engagements; the years in which the working habits were formed

Altec SA - Volunteer IT Assistant

Greece | Apr 2000 - Jun 2003 | 3 yrs 3 mths

- Hardware and computer-networking fundamentals, in-store equipment work, while still studying

SELF-DIRECTED ENGINEERING, 2025 - 2026 (GRADED, NOT EMPLOYER-ATTESTED)

Checked against repositories on disk, not against a memory of doing it.

- **Infrastructure as code with a gate that bites** (verified in code). Ansible across an estate: five roles, playbooks, executable inventory. The validation pipeline runs lint and policy checks and **fails the build**; the secret-scanning pattern width was chosen after measuring which fields it false-positived on, and a regression guard fails the build if a known-bad lint configuration returns.
- **Push-to-deploy pipelines** (verified run). One commit fans out to per-host deploy jobs on a self-hosted runner across five Linux hosts, converging state with Docker Compose, with deployment verification that re-runs against the live container instead of trusting the pipeline that changed it. The instructive failures were operational: a runner that terminated its own job by redeploying itself, secrets mangled in transport, and free-tier schedulers whose timing is not a control, so scheduled work is monitored externally.
- **Network isolation findings** (verified read-only). `firewall=1` filtered nothing on most guests, since with no ruleset the effective policy is accept, and an nft component ran programming zero tables. Both were believed controls.
- **Declarative provisioning** (verified code + local run). Proxmox guest definitions that `tofu validate` clean under OpenTofu 1.13.1. Nothing has been planned or applied against a host: no API token has been issued, so this is provisioning code that works, not a managed production estate.
- **Observability** (verified code). 22 monitored targets and 14 alert rules, deliberately small, each with a named recipient and an action.
- **Ariadne: deterministic CV/ATS parser (Python, dependency-free, typed failure codes, evidence-graded docs).** (VERIFIED, public code: `github.com/sternnick/Ariadne`, 1,443 lines of source, 4 test modules)
- **Evaluated and declined:** NetBox mapped seriously (data model, REST and GraphQL surfaces, IaC integration path) and not deployed, because the estate's change rate did not justify it.

CERTIFICATIONS, EDUCATION, LANGUAGES

- **AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional** (issued 2024, valid to 2027; published in the LinkedIn Licenses section)

- Google Digital Workshop
- **Technical and Vocational Upper Secondary**, Technician for Computers, Networks and Communications, Kavala, Greece (1999 - 2002)
- Additional IT training: Byte Computer S.A., Athens (2011 - 2012). Listed as training only: Byte appears nowhere on the live profile as an employer and is a subcontract source from the field years, not a job
- **Not held, recorded so nothing downstream re-adds it:** no Kubernetes certification (CKA/CKAD), no Terraform Associate, no Azure certification. Kubernetes experience is operational and self-taught
- Languages: Greek (native), English (professional)

AVAILABILITY

Remote, any timezone, immediately. Ireland-based; contractor or employee.